



ADRIAN MELIAN

LEAD / PRINCIPAL TECHNICAL ARTIST · FOUNDER

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SUMMARY

Technical artist who designs the systems other artists ship through. 14 years in AAA character rigging, skinning and tools across six proprietary engines. Promoted from Senior to Lead at Sledgehammer Games and led Character Tech Art then Weapons Tech Art across two Call of Duty titles. Founded FabricatorStudio in 2026 and launched Armature as a commercial product.

Engines	Buddha, 2HB, ASOBI, IW, Horizon, Snowdrop. Unity, Unreal 5.
Languages	Python, PySide, PyTorch, HLSL, MEL, C++, C#, Lua
Software	Maya, ZBrush, Substance Painter, ShotGrid, Perforce, Git
Leadership	Discipline ownership, mentorship, pipeline architecture, offshore and vendor management, technical roadmapping

EXPERIENCE

FabricatorStudio | Founder

Mar 2026 – Present

Denver, CO (Remote)

- Founded the studio and shipped its Maya pipeline toolset.
- Launched Armature as a standalone rigging and skinning app in August 2026.
- Shipped a toolset including: project setup, modular-rigging, auto-skinning, export, pose and animation library, and an AI technical assistant.
- Run as an Artist+AI studio.

Camouflaj @ Meta | Expert Technical Artist

Sep 2025 – Mar 2026

Remote

- Led the art team's move onto Meta's Horizon engine.
- Owned the animation feature gap analysis.
- Carried the studio's feature requests to Meta's Horizon engine team.
- Tracked a daily-changing engine build through the transition.

Sledgehammer Games | Senior Technical Artist, promoted to Lead Technical Artist

Jan 2021 – Sep 2025

Remote · Senior 2021–2022, Lead 2022–2025 · Call of Duty: Vanguard (2021) · Call of Duty: Modern Warfare III (2023)

- Built the Rig Model Updater so modelers could push model updates into engine without a technical artist.
- Led Character Tech Art then Weapons Tech Art across two shipped Call of Duty titles.
- Shipped the animation, rigging, cloth, preview and export tools the team worked in.
- Standardized the weapons rigging pipeline.
- Led PyTorch research into automated skin weighting.
- Ran weekly one-to-ones with every report and mentored one to a promotion.
- Set the craft bar on celebrity likenesses and owned in-engine character performance budgets.
- Grew the discipline through internal hiring and offshore management.
- Worked in the IW engine through its rebuild for Modern Warfare III.

Meta | Technical Artist

Nov 2018 – Dec 2020

Menlo Park, CA · Meta Horizon Worlds (2021)

- Built the animation exporter for VR production.
- Wrote a ShotGrid integration in Python that alerted directors to new animation cuts for review and notes.
- Shipped a Figma-to-React plugin.
- Profiled VR scenes to find the objects and areas costing performance.

Nomadic VR | Senior Technical Artist

Dec 2017 – Nov 2018

San Rafael, CA · Arizona Sunshine: Rampage (2018)

- Programmed the Unity control system for a servo-driven motion platform.
- Rigged the platform as a digital twin so moving the rig in engine moved the machine.
- Animated the platform with keyframes blended over sine waves for rumble and sway.
- Integrated Leap Motion hand tracking.
- Calibrated and owned the OptiTrack and Motive tracking volume.

NCSoft | Senior Technical Artist

Jan 2017 – Dec 2017

San Mateo, CA

- Built a modular auto-rigging system and batch rigging tools.
- Authored animation retargeting tools.
- Delivered 30+ hero and enemy rigs.

Ubisoft | Senior Technical Artist

Aug 2016 – Dec 2016

San Francisco, CA · South Park: The Fractured But Whole (2017)

- Rigged the game's 2D and 3D hybrid characters.
- Built the pipeline and 2D flipbook animation tools.
- Worked in the Snowdrop engine.

ToyTalk, Inc. (now PullString) | Senior Technical Artist

Oct 2015 – Jul 2016

San Francisco, CA

- Owned character rigging across multiple simultaneous projects.
- Built a pose and animation library, a Trax editor pipeline and lip-sync tools.
- Built Maya-to-Unity exporters.
- Authored procedural planetary shaders for galaxy rendering.
- Worked on a Minecraft collaboration between ToyTalk and Microsoft.

Perfect World Entertainment | Technical Artist

Feb 2015 – Oct 2015

Redwood City, CA

- Wrote a cel-shaded ocean shader by hand in HLSL.
- Learned shader programming and delivered it in two weeks.
- Built the shoreline from world edge detection, Gerstner wave displacement and a dynamic boat wake.

Double Fine Productions | Technical Artist

Jan 2012 – Nov 2014

San Francisco, CA · Broken Age, Costume Quest 2, Massive Chalice, Spacebase DF-9, The Cave, Happy Action Theater, My Alien Buddy, Kinect Party

- Modeled, rigged and skinned 40 of 48 characters on Broken Age.
- Built the flipbook animation system on Broken Age.
- Rigged and skinned 26 of 28 characters on Costume Quest 2.
- Animated gameplay and cutscenes on Costume Quest 2.
- Authored the Entity and Animation Preview tool in PyQt.
- Wrote a Simulation Generator in Python.
- Built a CSV-to-Maya map converter and a world randomizer on Massive Chalice.
- Created all characters and wrote the Lua intro on My Alien Buddy.
- Built the game on Sony's ASOBI engine on pre-launch PlayStation 4 dev kits.
- Shipped it with the PlayStation 4 launch.
- Wrote export tools for Unity and the ASOBI engine.
- Ported the studio's tools from Maya 8.5 to 2012 on Kinect Party.
- Rigged and skinned characters across four Amnesia Fortnight prototypes.
- Shipped on Double Fine's Buddha and 2HB engines.

Concept Art House | Technical Artist & Project Manager

Feb 2011 – Sep 2011

San Francisco, CA · Zoo World 2, Legacy of a Thousand Suns, Vegas City

- Built MEL auto-rigging tools for bipeds and quadrupeds.
- Managed outsourcing teams and tracked production across external partners.
- Wrote assignments, tutorials and style guides for the outsourced team.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

- Michael: the Archangel (Unreal). Solo action game. Creative direction, gameplay C++ and the character pipeline.
- Krazy Kaiju (Unreal). VR game built from scratch with hand-written C++ gameplay systems and an original score.

EDUCATION

B.S. Media Arts & Animation, Art Institute of California San Francisco. Best Portfolio Award, 2010.

Graphic Design, Sullivan County Community College (SUNY Sullivan), 2004 – 2006.